PLAYERS CODE OF CONDUCT POLICY

POLICY UPDATE

The Club has adopted Basketball Victoria Country Players Code of Conduct as prescribed by the Bendigo Basketball Association (BBA).

1. UNDERSTAND AND PLAY BY THE RULES

Understanding and playing by the rules is your responsibility. The rules exist for the safety, proper order and enjoyment of all people involved in basketball. The lessons to be learned in this respect in basketball are lessons that can and should be carried over into all aspects of your lives. Do not ignore or deliberately break any rules. Even if you think that a deliberate foul may give your team an advantage, you should not commit the deliberate foul in the interests of fair play. If you do consistently commit deliberate fouls or break the rules you must accept that there will be consequences for you and your team. Do not let yourself or your team down.

2. RESPECT REFEREES AND OTHER OFFICIALS

Referees and officials have a difficult task to perform and you could not play the game without them. They are there to enforce the rules of play but they cannot always be right. Accept bad calls graciously. Abuse of referees is unacceptable behaviour. Players who consistently dispute decisions or do not accept bad decisions are bad sports. If you disagree with a decision, have your coach, captain or manager approach the referee during a break or after the game, in an appropriate manner.

3. CONTROL YOUR TEMPER

Verbal abuse of officials is a serious offence against the rules of basketball. Verbally abusing other players or deliberately distracting or provoking an opponent is also not acceptable or permitted in basketball. Loss of temper is unpleasant for other players, and it can distract you and have an adverse effect on your concentration and effectiveness on the court.

4. WORK EQUALLY HARD FOR YOURSELF AND FOR YOUR TEAM

You owe it to yourself and others involved in your team to train and play to the best of your ability. Your team's performance will benefit and so will you. If you are half-hearted about your involvement in the sport you will become dissatisfied and lose out on the much of the enjoyment and satisfaction you can derive from giving it your best.

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5. BE A GOOD SPORT

Acknowledge all good play by your team and the other team. Good manners and respect can be infectious. Everyone likes to be praised when they do something well. If you acknowledge the achievements of your opponents it is likely they will follow suit. Part of participation in sport is respect for all participants in the game. Your opponents are entitled to proper courtesy. Always introduce yourself to your opponents on court and congratulate them whether you win or lose. Be sporting in victory and graceful in defeat. Remember that the opposition coach is trying to do the best for their team and is also entitled to respect.

7. PLAY FOR THE "ENJOYMENT OF IT" AND NOT JUST TO PLEASE PARENTS AND COACHES

Playing sport should be fun. You can take it seriously, but you should enjoy it at the same time. If you enjoy an activity you will perform much better and derive far more benefit from it than if it is an unpleasant experience. You may experience pressure from your coach and parents and others to perform outside of your capability or desires. Whilst this can be positive and their way of showing you support in your activities, you should resist it if it no longer is enjoyable.

9. BE PREPARED TO LOSE SOMETIMES

Everyone wins and loses at some time. Be a fair winner and a good loser. Disappointment at losing is natural, but it should not be obvious to the point of being unpleasant for others. Just as unpleasant can be the boastful winner. Recognise that even in defeat, the loser has achieved something, just by playing. Not everything in life can be a winning situation. Losing can be an important learning experience for your wider life goals.

6. TREAT OTHER PLAYERS JUST AS YOU WOULD LIKE TO BE TREATED.

Do not interfere with, bully or take unfair advantage of another player. Just because a teammate cannot perform as well as you does not mean they are not trying. Everyone makes mistakes. Do not abuse or ridicule another player when a mistake is made. Constructive guidance and encouragement when a player does well will assist a player to improve their game.

8. RESPECT THE RIGHTS, DIGNITY AND WORTH OF EVERY PERSON

Regardless of their gender, ability, cultural background, religion or other factor irrelevant to the game, all persons connected with basketball are entitled to equal treatment and respect. Avoid any remarks that could be construed as offensive or discriminatory. Sometimes even a joke may give offence. Even if someone refers to himself or herself with a particular label, it should not be taken as an invitation for you to do so. Using discretion is imperative and it is better to err on the side of caution.

10. LISTEN TO YOUR COACH

Your coach has been appointed to coach your team because they have certain abilities and experience. They have also undergone training to ensure that you get the best coach that you can commensurate with your skill levels. Apart from skills training, your coach can provide you with helpful advice on all aspects of playing basketball. Make the most of the opportunity provided to you to work with your coach to have a happy and successful experience in basketball.

11. ALWAYS RESPECT THE USE OF FACILITES AND EQUIPMENT PROVIDED

Facilities and equipment cost money and will only function properly if kept in good order. Ensure that you do not abuse anything provided for use. Do not engage in dangerous practices such as hanging off hoops or “slam dunking”. Quite properly, these practices are banned in most venues. Equipment can be damaged and serious injury can occur.

12. DISCLOSURE

Names of persons suspended will be listed on the basketball notice board for breaches of the code of conduct that are viewed at the tribunal.